



Lost cause: Tanking is one of the worst sins — if not the worst — that tennis players like Bernard Tomic have committed. It also shortchanges and angers spectators, tournament directors, opponents, the media, and sponsors. GETTY IMAGES

opponents, test the goodwill of ATP and WTA physiotherapists, and disappoint tournament directors, TV networks, and spectators. While these rascals sometimes get away with it and win the match, they end up losing the respect of their colleagues.

Pointless replays and challenges — Asking for a replay or challenging a line call that was

obviously very far in or out. In 2025, the ATP Tour will use Electronic Line Calling Live — known as ELC Live — for all 'out' calls in all matches. Until then, umpires will indulge players who exploit the current Player Challenge rule and delay play for no good reason.

Hypersensitive players — These babies can deal with the roar of the crowd during high-pressure points but get bent out of shape and refuse

to play following a changeover because a couple of spectators way up on Row 37 in the stadium are unobtrusively returning to their seats. You cannot be serious!

Tanking — What Nick Kyrgios, Bernard Tomic, and Benoit Paire have done in this era and what Marat Safin did 15 years ago produces more than peeved reactions. Tanking is defined as intentionally losing a match by not trying. Typically, that means either not

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